

AND

FANTASTIC UNIVERSE

SCIENCE FICTION

MAY

35c



*There Was Fear in the Hearts of Men
and the Brilliance of the Galaxy Was Dimmed until*

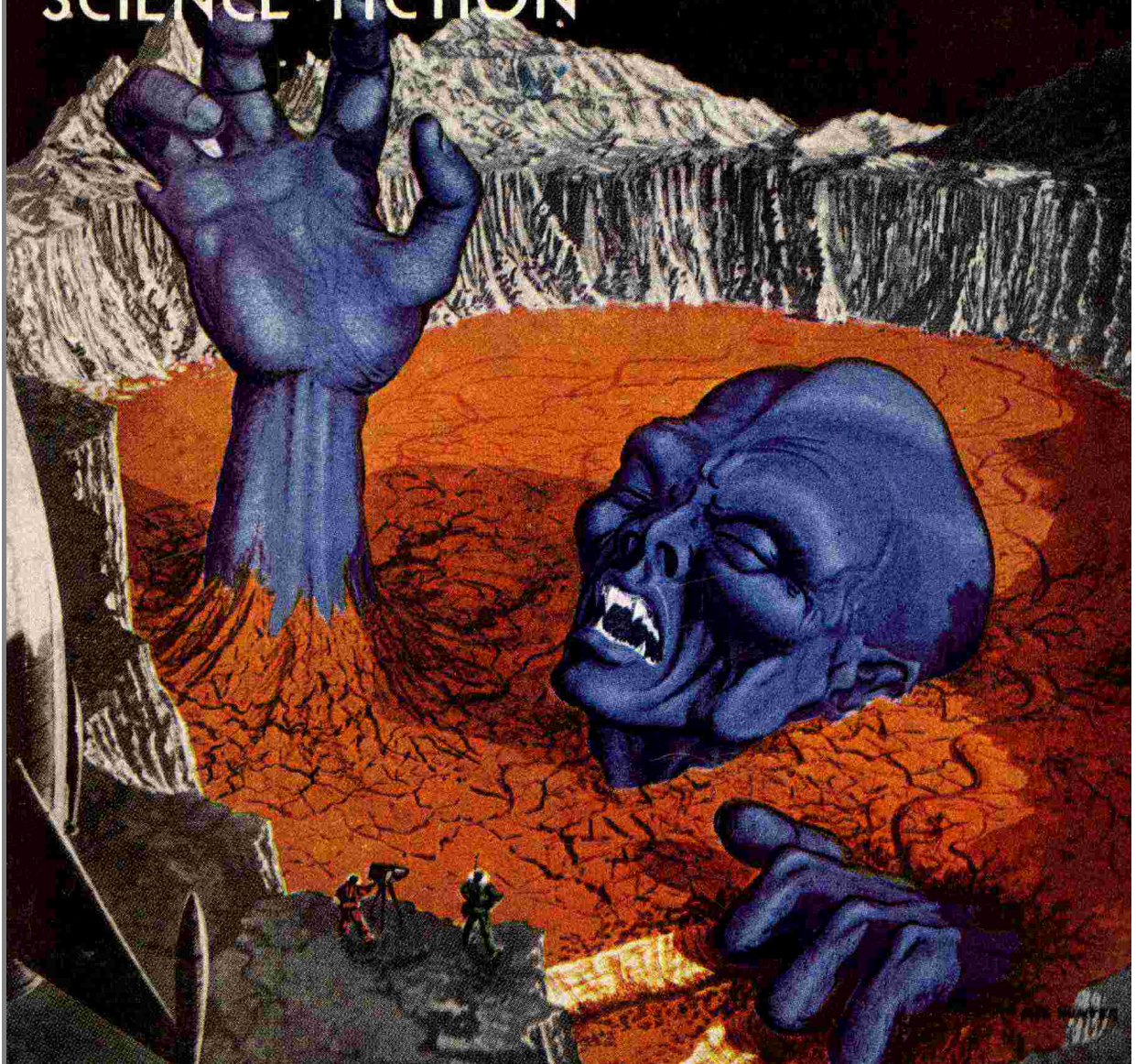
THE WHITE RAIN CAME by Jacques Jean Ferrat

ANC

FANTASTIC UNIVERSE

SCIENCE FICTION

MAY
35c



*There Was Fear in the Hearts of Men
and the Brilliance of the Galaxy Was Dimmed until . . .*

THE WHITE RAIN CAME by Jacques Jean Ferrat

The Project Gutenberg eBook of Pink grass planet

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg License included with this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

Title: Pink grass planet

Author: Jr. Sam Merwin

Illustrator: Mel Hunter

Release date: March 8, 2026 [eBook #78138]

Language: English

Original publication: New York: King-Size Publications, Inc., 1955

Other information and formats: www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/78138

Credits: Tom Trussel (This file was produced from images generously made available by The Internet Archive)

*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK PINK GRASS
PLANET ***

Transcribed from Fantastic Universe, May 1955 (Vol. 3, No. 4.).

Pink Grass Planet

by **Sam Merwin Jr.**

In offering this delightful new Sam Merwin story to you we may be inviting just about the worst disaster that could befall an editor of a science-fantasy magazine. For, given man's eternal restlessness and his all-too-frequent subservience to fads and fancies, the tragedy so vividly depicted here may someday come true. Then we'll be accused of being an accessory before the fact, and suffer the harsh fate of prophets everywhere. A dire risk, truly!

**A man may grieve his heart out for a paradise left behind.
But five short years of human folly may make that world a
nightmare.**

The starship landed at night. When Ricardo Webb stepped out on the ramp, the first thing he did was take a deep breath of the sharp, strange-familiar air of Earth. When he exhaled, in the glow of the fluorescent field-lamps, he could see a little cloud of vapor emerge and dissipate quickly against the brisk November night.

He told himself he would never curse a terrestrial winter again. After five years in the tepid showerbath air of Lri-gTu-riANa, he even looked forward to shoveling snow. This was Earth, this was home—and it felt good to be back. Better than good, in fact.

He stared about him, searching for a warmth and a radiance that would make his happiness complete. Then Carla spun out of the whirling group of reporters, officials and just plain people who had come to meet the starship, and flung herself into his arms. “Ricci, darling!” She whispered, twisting her pretty face so that her lips met his almost vertically.

He thought, *I’ll have to do something about that*. He held her supple softness off at arm’s length and said, “Do I know you?”

“Idiot!” She laughed and kissed him again. “Come on,” she said. “Mother’s cooking a turkey, and dad can’t wait to ask you about fishing on Liguria.”

Lri-gTu-riANa—Liguria. The contraction simplified the name for Earth-tongues, but it sounded odd to Ricardo. He hoped not too many of the once-familiar place names of Earth would sound odd to his ears. He wanted to forget about Lri-gTu-riANa for awhile, and rejoice in the incredible bright wonder of his homecoming. He said: “They use needle-rays instead of dry flies on—Liguria. It’s not the same.”

“Idiot!” she said again, affectionately. “I don’t give a *fringo* how they catch fish on Liguria—that’s for dad. I’m just glad you’re back.” She hugged his elbow. “I’ve got an aircar waiting.”

Fringo! He wondered where Carla had picked that one up. It was a Lri-gTu-riANan expression, not entirely decent by accepted terrestrial standards. But no one who had not been to Lri-gTu-riANa would know. He wondered if he’d ever get used to calling the planet of his exile Liguria.

A Vidar newscaster intercepted them before they reached the aircar beyond the administration building. Ricardo enjoyed the man’s nasal, staccato

chatter after the soft slow accents he had been forced to listen to from dawn to dusk for five long years. The man said, turning his vidamike toward Carla so that she, too, would appear on two hundred million precision-tuned screens, “Mr. Webb, I see you’ve got a real honeycomb with you. Tell me, how does she look to you after the Ligurian *Fraislies*?”

“Great—just great!” said Ricardo sincerely.

He wondered, feeling a pang of conscience, just how much people on Earth knew about the *fraislies*—and how much they could accept without lifting their eyebrows. Everything was so different on the first civilized planet man had discovered. And Ricardo had discovered how thoroughly even the most pleasant exoticism can pall. He was relieved when the newscaster moved on to another returnee.

Carla and he took off as soon as his luggage had been inspected and cleared. He gave her the ring which he had had fashioned of a single chunk of pale blue, luminous Ligurian jade. She kissed him again as she slipped it on her fourth finger, atop the diamond-and-platinum engagement ring she had been wearing for five years.

“Oh, *darling*!” she murmured. “This is the loveliest thing! The other girls will hate me for having it—and for having you.”

This time, when their lips met, he held her face upright between his palms. But when he moved his hands lower to caress her, she twisted her head again so her lips crossed his almost vertically. But so ardent was the embrace that he didn’t really care. It was pleasantly dark and warm in the aircar, and the cushions were soft, and the automatic pilot was doing all the work....

Carla’s mother, wearing a plastapron, met them at the door. She was a pale, plump woman, who twittered like a fluttering, migratory bird. She had set her face sternly against her daughter’s engagement to Ricardo but now that he had returned indisputably famous she chose to believe that the selection of Carla’s fiancé had been hers alone.

Ricardo was relieved when she fled to the kitchen, twittering over a bare pink shoulder, “I had the bird stuffed with *loocoo-sran* berries, in honor of your arrival, Ricci. Won’t that be divinely nice?”

He was sure the berries would spoil his meal. If there was one thing he had developed a hatred for, beyond all others on Lri-gTu-riANa, it was the all-pervasive sweet-sour tartness of the *loocoo-sran* ingredient in that planet's cuisine. It was a standing joke in the Earth-colony that their hosts used *loocoo-sran* berries to brush their teeth, so the flavor would remain with them between meals to bolster up their egos.

Carla darted into her room and Mr. Baker put an arm across Ricardo's shoulders and led him to the servabar at one end of the living room. He was a large, hearty man with a booming voice. He said, "It's good to have you back, son. I think the occasion demands a little liquid refreshment. I picked up a case of *praglian* yesterday, in honor of your arrival."

Praglian! The thought of its thick, sweetish flavor made him physically ill. There had been a time, during the early portion of his stay on Lri-gTu-riANa, when he had enjoyed drinking the stuff. There had also been a time, before he went to Lri-gTu-riANa, when he would simply have told Mr. Baker he'd rather have whiskey—good straight Earth whiskey, 90 proof. But five years of Lri-gTu-riANan politeness had made such candor impossible. He drank *praglian*, and tried not to make a face.

Carla came wandering in, wearing snowy white boots, shorts and bolero jacket. She looked adorable, and she felt adorable as she snuggled close to him and took a sip from his glass. There was just one flaw. Now that she had her hat off, he saw that her naturally auburn hair had been dyed a pale Ligurian green.

"Why did you do it, honey?" he asked her, no longer able to obey the inner compulsion toward politeness he had acquired on the alien planet.

She thrust a laughing face up at him and said, "Isn't it *crspaltish*? All the girls are doing it lately. It's the absolute rage."

Of course, she mispronounced *crspaltish*. But Ricardo didn't correct her. The less Ligurian he heard, he told himself bitterly, the better he was going to like it.

To his surprise, he enjoyed the dinner. Apparently, the *loocoo-sran* berries had been adulterated to suit terrestrial palates, or else he was so used to the flavor that his own taste had become blunted. At any rate, the radar-cooked turkey was marvelous—crisp and brown on the outside, and unbelievably

tender and white within. And the rest of the food was untainted with Ligurian seasonings. He ate until the lastex band of his clout made groves against the skin of his stomach.

Satiated, he sat on the living room sofa, his fingers entwined with Carla's, and wondered why anyone should want to go to Lri-gTu-riANa when Earth was so much better, so much more suited to the race of men. In the dim light, he had to look hard to see that Carla's hair was Ligurian green. He didn't strain his eyes.

Mrs. Baker, in the rockofit chair, was wearing the *flausmraka* bolero he had brought her, and Mr. Baker, in his layback seat, was puffing on the tube of the Ligurian *clisra*-pipe Ricardo had dug out of his luggage right after dinner. He hadn't quite mastered the technique and made faint slurping sounds at regular intervals.

"I'm so *glad* you're back," Carla whispered, close to his ear. "It was worth waiting five years for. Or an eternity," she added, snuggling even closer to him.

Ricardo gave her hand a squeeze. This was Earth. This was home. This was Carla, glorious in bolero jacket and snowy boots.

At nine o'clock the vidar announcer appeared and said, "And now, Rafflex Exterminator, the exterminator that terminates, presents its long-awaited ninety-minute superspectacular in tri-di triple-color—*Life on Liguria!* See the famous authentic *shlastric* festival, learn how the seductive *loofahs* select their mates, thrill to the excitement and danger of a *kifs*-hunt in the deadly *snree-achian* jungle, all brought to you by courtesy of Rafflex Exterminator, the ex—"

"Come on, honey," said Ricardo, getting to his feet. "Let's take a walk. Will you excuse us, Mrs. Baker?"

Mrs. Baker was so deeply engrossed in the vidar that he had to repeat the question twice.

Outside, the night was warm—Carla lived almost a thousand miles south of the spaceport—and the moon was as large and mellow as a lump of unsalted butter. It looked dangerously huge and close to Ricardo, accustomed as he was to the four swift and tiny satellites of Lri-gTu-riANa. But the poplars whispered in the soft breeze and the grass of the lawn was

crisply tender beneath his feet. Carla kissed him—sideways, Liguria-style again—and then said with a sigh, “That’s what I love about you most, Ricci. You’re so courtly and polite. Asking mother if we could take a walk! I don’t even mind your having had a *loofa* on Liguria.”

“What makes you think I had a *loofa*?” he asked.

“Silly! Doesn’t everyone?” she countered. “When in Rome....”

“As a matter of fact, there wasn’t much choice,” he told her.

He was glad, in a way, that she had accepted the fact that his years on Lri-gTu-riANa had not been celibate. Yet her easy acquiescence bothered him a little. It seemed—un-Earthlike. It would have been more in character if she had given him hell. It would have been more flattering to his ego. In her casual acceptance of a biological frailty, she seemed almost like a *fraislie*.

No one who had not lived on the planet could ever really understand its society. Not that the natives weren’t surprisingly human. In sober fact they came as close to being human as any race could without actually belonging to the same species. But their society had developed along more temperate lines. After all, Lri-gTu-riANa was a milder planet than Earth.

There were no sex crimes on Lri-gTu-riANa, because there was no sexual repression. Mating had been reduced to a mere social pleasure—almost as casually accepted as the custom of shaking hands on Earth. The only thing outlawed on Lri-gTu-riANa was ugliness in any shape or form. That hatred of ugliness had been the most difficult factor for the Earth visitors to adjust to. No matter how useful anything was, no matter how sorely needed—if it was ugly, it was out—O-U-T, *out*!

Without closing his eyes, Ricardo could see in vivid visual retrospect his red-headed chief, Captain Luders, turning scarlet with exasperation. He had not been allowed to employ a water-purifier simply because the natives hadn’t thought it looked beautiful enough.

He could hear Luders storming, in the seclusion of the inner office, “Damned pink, candy-box world! I’m beginning to feel like the little man on a wedding cake. For five credits, I’d....”

What Luders would have done for five credits had been both obscene and explicit. But the incident had occurred during the early months, before one

of the loveliest *fraislies* on Lri-gTu-riANa became the captain's *loofa*. Luders had lost a lot of rough edges in the years since, and had become a great stickler for beauty, naked and unadorned.

Ricardo was brought back to Earth with a thud. Carla was talking about plans for their wedding, talking joyously and excitedly about showers and luncheons and bridesmaids costumes. He heard himself say, "Can't that wait till tomorrow, honey? I'm a little beat."

Instantly he wondered why he'd said it. For five years, he had lived with the constant, gloriously sustaining thought of marrying Carla the moment he got back to Earth. It had been like the proverbial bottle of whiskey at the end of the ditch. He had even feared that she might turn faithless, or be swept off her feet by another man. He had inwardly denied himself full, and traditionally customary satisfaction with his own *loofa*, preserving a tiny part of himself for her alone.

They had thought him a cold fish on Lri-gTu-riANa, because of Carla. Yet here he was, putting off the very thing he'd held himself aloof for. Aloof-a *loofa*. As he undressed for the night, he wondered if space-cafard hadn't got him. Certainly his behavior and feelings had not been wholly rational. Quite the reverse....

When he awoke the next morning, the sun—Earth's sun, *his* sun—was shining low and bright in the east. Birds—Earth-birds—were singing their morning songs and a faint, wonderful aroma of coffee came through the window from the kitchen wing of the house. All the confusion, all the uncertainty, all the self-doubt of the night before had been washed away. Ricardo stretched lazily, then rose and shuffled across the carpet to look out the window.

He actually cried out with horror at what he saw.

It seemed like nightmare, but—it wasn't at all. The neat lawn and trim poplars were a rich, familiar pink. If it hadn't been for the green of the hills west of the town, he'd have thought himself still on Lri-gTu-riANa. Dazed, he turned away from the shocking spectacle just as Carla, who had heard him cry out, came into the room.

He said, "What's happened to the trees, to the lawn?"

She looked pleased, even a little smug. She said, “Isn’t it simply *crspaltish*, Ricci? We were the very first in town to use chlorodyll on our grass. You know, the stuff that makes the foliage pink on Liguria.”

“I know,” Ricardo said grimly.

“The best part of it is that it won’t turn green again,” she told him proudly. “And it doesn’t spread, so no one can use it who hasn’t paid for it.”

“Praise Allah for small blessings,” said Ricardo, appalled.

“What’s that?” Carla wanted to know.

“Oh, nothing,” he muttered, running a hand through his hair.

“Now almost everybody has chlorodyll grass,” the girl went on. “Out West, in farming districts, the big owners hire aircars to dust the prairies. In a few years, the whole world will be pink.”

Ricardo thought despairingly of the green hills of Earth, for which he had longed for so many years. He thought of the dark tropical forests, of the mosses of the Arctic tundra, of the great grasslands of Africa, Asia and South America. All pink, passionate cake-frosting pink! Or soon to be. He closed his eyes.

Carla kept on talking. “And tonight, they’re having a ball in our honor at the country club. It’s going to be just like a *shlastric* festival and some of the girls say they’re going to be real *loofas*. It’s becoming quite the thing. But mother and I don’t think it’s exactly proper unless they’re married. I want you to see my costume, right after breakfast, to be sure it’s a hundred per cent authentic.”

He opened his eyes. He said, “Beat it, honey, will you? I want to take a shower and get dressed.”

He didn’t shower at once. Instead, he sat on the edge of the bed, being careful to assume an angle that forbade his seeing the pink foliage outside. He thought of the young people of Earth, ardently pursuing Ligurian customs, turning the planet into an imitation of Lri-gTu-riANa. He thought

of girls like Carla turning *loofa*. At least, on Lri-gTu-riANa, it was the real thing.

He packed his bag and got dressed and walked through the French window, across the pink grass to the street. He hailed a passing vehicle and was given a lift to the skyport. There, he caught an aircab north to the spaceport.

The interstellar official looked at him curiously as he reported. He was a man of native curiosity, which was why he held the job he did. It was a job where questions were important. He said, “You’re sure you want to go back for a ten-year hitch. Not that we aren’t glad to have an old Liguria-hand back. But you haven’t given yourself much time here on Earth. Your girl run out on you?”

“No,” Ricardo didn’t want to waste time talking. He wouldn’t feel safe until he was aboard the big gleaming starship awaiting its payload at the end of the ramp outside. “Just say, I think I’m better suited to life on Lri-gTu-riANa after five years there.”

“Sure you don’t want a little more time to adjust. It’s a big decision. And ten years is—”

“Ten years is the longest hitch I can sign for,” said Ricardo. “I intend to stay on Lri-gTu-riANa for life.”

“Well, we’re not going to stop you,” said the official. “Care for a spot of *praglian*? One for the road?”

“Why not?” said Ricardo as the official bent to open a drawer. He was going to drink *praglian* from now on and like it. He clinked glasses with his host and downed the Ligurian brew. It was warm and sweet and not unpleasant on his tongue.

“By the way,” said the official, nodding toward a large carton that stood beside Ricardo’s bags, “if it’s not hush-hush, would you mind telling me why you’re spending credits taking seeds to a fertile planet like Lri-gTu-riANa?”

“Because,” said Ricardo, speaking slowly, “I’m going to turn the whole damned planet green.”

Transcriber’s note:

This etext was produced from Fantastic Universe, May 1955 (Vol. 3, No. 4.). Extensive research did not uncover any evidence that the U.S. copyright on this publication was renewed.

Obvious errors have been silently corrected in this version, but minor inconsistencies have been retained as printed.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK PINK GRASS
PLANET ***

Updated editions will replace the previous one—the old editions will be renamed.

Creating the works from print editions not protected by U.S. copyright law means that no one owns a United States copyright in these works, so the Foundation (and you!) can copy and distribute it in the United States without permission and without paying copyright royalties. Special rules, set forth in the General Terms of Use part of this license, apply to copying and distributing Project Gutenberg™ electronic works to protect the PROJECT GUTENBERG™ concept and trademark. Project Gutenberg is a registered trademark, and may not be used if you charge for an eBook, except by following the terms of the trademark license, including paying royalties for use of the Project Gutenberg trademark. If you do not charge anything for copies of this eBook, complying with the trademark license is very easy. You may use this eBook for nearly any purpose such as creation of derivative works, reports, performances and research. Project Gutenberg eBooks may be modified and printed and given away—you may do practically ANYTHING in the United States with eBooks not protected by U.S. copyright law. Redistribution is subject to the trademark license, especially commercial redistribution.

START: FULL LICENSE

THE FULL PROJECT GUTENBERG™ LICENSE

PLEASE READ THIS BEFORE YOU DISTRIBUTE OR USE THIS WORK

To protect the Project Gutenberg™ mission of promoting the free distribution of electronic works, by using or distributing this work (or any other work associated in any way with the phrase “Project Gutenberg”), you agree to comply with all the terms of the Full Project Gutenberg License available with this file or online at www.gutenberg.org/license.

Section 1. General Terms of Use and Redistributing Project Gutenberg electronic works

1.A. By reading or using any part of this Project Gutenberg electronic work, you indicate that you have read, understand, agree to and accept all the terms of this license and intellectual property (trademark/copyright) agreement. If you do not agree to abide by all the terms of this agreement, you must cease using and return or destroy all copies of Project Gutenberg electronic works in your possession. If you paid a fee for obtaining a copy of or access to a Project Gutenberg electronic work and you do not agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement, you may obtain a refund from the person or entity to whom you paid the fee as set forth in paragraph 1.E.8.

1.B. “Project Gutenberg” is a registered trademark. It may only be used on or associated in any way with an electronic work by people who agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement. There are a few things that you can do with most Project Gutenberg electronic works even without complying with the full terms of this agreement. See paragraph 1.C below. There are a lot of things you can do with Project Gutenberg electronic works if you follow the terms of this agreement and help preserve free future access to Project Gutenberg electronic works. See paragraph 1.E below.

1.C. The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation (“the Foundation” or PGLAF), owns a compilation copyright in the collection of Project Gutenberg electronic works. Nearly all the individual works in the collection are in the public domain in the United States. If an individual work is unprotected by copyright law in the United States and you are

located in the United States, we do not claim a right to prevent you from copying, distributing, performing, displaying or creating derivative works based on the work as long as all references to Project Gutenberg are removed. Of course, we hope that you will support the Project Gutenberg mission of promoting free access to electronic works by freely sharing Project Gutenberg works in compliance with the terms of this agreement for keeping the Project Gutenberg name associated with the work. You can easily comply with the terms of this agreement by keeping this work in the same format with its attached full Project Gutenberg License when you share it without charge with others.

1.D. The copyright laws of the place where you are located also govern what you can do with this work. Copyright laws in most countries are in a constant state of change. If you are outside the United States, check the laws of your country in addition to the terms of this agreement before downloading, copying, displaying, performing, distributing or creating derivative works based on this work or any other Project Gutenberg work. The Foundation makes no representations concerning the copyright status of any work in any country other than the United States.

1.E. Unless you have removed all references to Project Gutenberg:

1.E.1. The following sentence, with active links to, or other immediate access to, the full Project Gutenberg License must appear prominently whenever any copy of a Project Gutenberg work (any work on which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” appears, or with which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” is associated) is accessed, displayed, performed, viewed, copied or distributed:

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg™ License included with this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

1.E.2. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is derived from texts not protected by U.S. copyright law (does not contain a notice indicating that it is posted with permission of the copyright holder), the work can be copied and distributed to anyone in the United States without paying any fees or charges. If you are redistributing or providing access to a work with the phrase “Project Gutenberg” associated with or appearing on the work, you must comply either with the requirements of paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 or obtain permission for the use of the work and the Project Gutenberg trademark as set forth in paragraphs 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.3. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is posted with the permission of the copyright holder, your use and distribution must comply with both paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 and any additional terms imposed by the copyright holder. Additional terms will be linked to the Project Gutenberg License for all works posted with the permission of the copyright holder found at the beginning of this work.

1.E.4. Do not unlink or detach or remove the full Project Gutenberg License terms from this work, or any files containing a part of this work or any other work associated with Project Gutenberg.

1.E.5. Do not copy, display, perform, distribute or redistribute this electronic work, or any part of this electronic work, without prominently displaying the sentence set forth in paragraph 1.E.1 with active links or immediate access to the full terms of the Project Gutenberg License.

1.E.6. You may convert to and distribute this work in any binary, compressed, marked up, nonproprietary or proprietary form, including any word processing or hypertext form. However, if you provide access to or distribute copies of a Project Gutenberg work in a format other than “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other format used in the official version posted on the official Project Gutenberg website (www.gutenberg.org), you must, at no additional cost, fee or expense to the user, provide a copy, a means of exporting a copy, or a means of obtaining a copy upon request, of the work in its original “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other form. Any alternate format must include the full Project Gutenberg License as specified in paragraph 1.E.1.

1.E.7. Do not charge a fee for access to, viewing, displaying, performing, copying or distributing any Project Gutenberg works unless you comply with paragraph 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.8. You may charge a reasonable fee for copies of or providing access to or distributing Project Gutenberg electronic works provided that:

- You pay a royalty fee of 20% of the gross profits you derive from the use of Project Gutenberg works calculated using the method you already use to calculate your applicable taxes. The fee is owed to the owner of the Project Gutenberg trademark, but he has agreed to donate royalties under this paragraph to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation. Royalty payments must be paid within 60 days following each date on which you prepare (or are legally required to prepare) your periodic tax returns. Royalty payments should be clearly marked as such and sent to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation at the address specified in Section 4, "Information about donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation."
- You provide a full refund of any money paid by a user who notifies you in writing (or by e-mail) within 30 days of receipt that s/he does not agree to the terms of the full Project Gutenberg™ License. You must require such a user to return or destroy all copies of the works possessed in a physical medium and discontinue all use of and all access to other copies of Project Gutenberg™ works.
- You provide, in accordance with paragraph 1.F.3, a full refund of any money paid for a work or a replacement copy, if a defect in the electronic work is discovered and reported to you within 90 days of receipt of the work.
- You comply with all other terms of this agreement for free distribution of Project Gutenberg™ works.

1.E.9. If you wish to charge a fee or distribute a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work or group of works on different terms than are set forth in this agreement, you must obtain permission in writing from the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the manager of the Project

Gutenberg™ trademark. Contact the Foundation as set forth in Section 3 below.

1.F.

1.F.1. Project Gutenberg volunteers and employees expend considerable effort to identify, do copyright research on, transcribe and proofread works not protected by U.S. copyright law in creating the Project Gutenberg™ collection. Despite these efforts, Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, and the medium on which they may be stored, may contain “Defects,” such as, but not limited to, incomplete, inaccurate or corrupt data, transcription errors, a copyright or other intellectual property infringement, a defective or damaged disk or other medium, a computer virus, or computer codes that damage or cannot be read by your equipment.

1.F.2. LIMITED WARRANTY, DISCLAIMER OF DAMAGES - Except for the “Right of Replacement or Refund” described in paragraph 1.F.3, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the owner of the Project Gutenberg™ trademark, and any other party distributing a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work under this agreement, disclaim all liability to you for damages, costs and expenses, including legal fees. YOU AGREE THAT YOU HAVE NO REMEDIES FOR NEGLIGENCE, STRICT LIABILITY, BREACH OF WARRANTY OR BREACH OF CONTRACT EXCEPT THOSE PROVIDED IN PARAGRAPH 1.F.3. YOU AGREE THAT THE FOUNDATION, THE TRADEMARK OWNER, AND ANY DISTRIBUTOR UNDER THIS AGREEMENT WILL NOT BE LIABLE TO YOU FOR ACTUAL, DIRECT, INDIRECT, CONSEQUENTIAL, PUNITIVE OR INCIDENTAL DAMAGES EVEN IF YOU GIVE NOTICE OF THE POSSIBILITY OF SUCH DAMAGE.

1.F.3. LIMITED RIGHT OF REPLACEMENT OR REFUND - If you discover a defect in this electronic work within 90 days of receiving it, you can receive a refund of the money (if any) you paid for it by sending a written explanation to the person you received the work from. If you received the work on a physical medium, you must return the medium with your written explanation. The person or entity that provided you with the defective work may elect to provide a replacement copy in lieu of a refund. If you received the work electronically, the person or entity providing it to

you may choose to give you a second opportunity to receive the work electronically in lieu of a refund. If the second copy is also defective, you may demand a refund in writing without further opportunities to fix the problem.

1.F.4. Except for the limited right of replacement or refund set forth in paragraph 1.F.3, this work is provided to you 'AS-IS', WITH NO OTHER WARRANTIES OF ANY KIND, EXPRESS OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING BUT NOT LIMITED TO WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY OR FITNESS FOR ANY PURPOSE.

1.F.5. Some states do not allow disclaimers of certain implied warranties or the exclusion or limitation of certain types of damages. If any disclaimer or limitation set forth in this agreement violates the law of the state applicable to this agreement, the agreement shall be interpreted to make the maximum disclaimer or limitation permitted by the applicable state law. The invalidity or unenforceability of any provision of this agreement shall not void the remaining provisions.

1.F.6. INDEMNITY - You agree to indemnify and hold the Foundation, the trademark owner, any agent or employee of the Foundation, anyone providing copies of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works in accordance with this agreement, and any volunteers associated with the production, promotion and distribution of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, harmless from all liability, costs and expenses, including legal fees, that arise directly or indirectly from any of the following which you do or cause to occur: (a) distribution of this or any Project Gutenberg work, (b) alteration, modification, or additions or deletions to any Project Gutenberg work, and (c) any Defect you cause.

Section 2. Information about the Mission of Project Gutenberg

Project Gutenberg is synonymous with the free distribution of electronic works in formats readable by the widest variety of computers including obsolete, old, middle-aged and new computers. It exists because of the

efforts of hundreds of volunteers and donations from people in all walks of life.

Volunteers and financial support to provide volunteers with the assistance they need are critical to reaching Project Gutenberg's goals and ensuring that the Project Gutenberg collection will remain freely available for generations to come. In 2001, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation was created to provide a secure and permanent future for Project Gutenberg and future generations. To learn more about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation and how your efforts and donations can help, see Sections 3 and 4 and the Foundation information page at www.gutenberg.org.

Section 3. Information about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation is a non-profit 501(c)(3) educational corporation organized under the laws of the state of Mississippi and granted tax exempt status by the Internal Revenue Service. The Foundation's EIN or federal tax identification number is 64-6221541. Contributions to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation are tax deductible to the full extent permitted by U.S. federal laws and your state's laws.

The Foundation's business office is located at 41 Watchung Plaza #516, Montclair NJ 07042, USA, +1 (862) 621-9288. Email contact links and up to date contact information can be found at the Foundation's website and official page at www.gutenberg.org/contact

Section 4. Information about Donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

Project Gutenberg™ depends upon and cannot survive without widespread public support and donations to carry out its mission of increasing the number of public domain and licensed works that can be freely distributed in machine-readable form accessible by the widest array of equipment

including outdated equipment. Many small donations (\$1 to \$5,000) are particularly important to maintaining tax exempt status with the IRS.

The Foundation is committed to complying with the laws regulating charities and charitable donations in all 50 states of the United States. Compliance requirements are not uniform and it takes a considerable effort, much paperwork and many fees to meet and keep up with these requirements. We do not solicit donations in locations where we have not received written confirmation of compliance. To SEND DONATIONS or determine the status of compliance for any particular state visit www.gutenberg.org/donate.

While we cannot and do not solicit contributions from states where we have not met the solicitation requirements, we know of no prohibition against accepting unsolicited donations from donors in such states who approach us with offers to donate.

International donations are gratefully accepted, but we cannot make any statements concerning tax treatment of donations received from outside the United States. U.S. laws alone swamp our small staff.

Please check the Project Gutenberg web pages for current donation methods and addresses. Donations are accepted in a number of other ways including checks, online payments and credit card donations. To donate, please visit: www.gutenberg.org/donate.

Section 5. General Information About Project Gutenberg electronic works

Professor Michael S. Hart was the originator of the Project Gutenberg concept of a library of electronic works that could be freely shared with anyone. For forty years, he produced and distributed Project Gutenberg eBooks with only a loose network of volunteer support.

Project Gutenberg eBooks are often created from several printed editions, all of which are confirmed as not protected by copyright in the U.S. unless a

copyright notice is included. Thus, we do not necessarily keep eBooks in compliance with any particular paper edition.

Most people start at our website which has the main PG search facility:
www.gutenberg.org.

This website includes information about Project Gutenberg, including how to make donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, how to help produce our new eBooks, and how to subscribe to our email newsletter to hear about new eBooks.